

Gmailify' everything

Why should your non-Gmail accounts not have the features Gmail has to offer? Gmailify them now! <http://dgit.in/GmailifyIt>



'Being' them!

View Instagram feed from anyone's eyes, as it would be shown to your BFF or your Favourite pop star using the app Being <http://dgit.in/BeingThem>

Budget smartphones

On the other hand, the build quality of the Kult 10 is commendable. The OnePlus-like sandstone finish on the back cover, provides good grip, and adds more grace to the orthodox candy-bar design. The 5-inch 720p display on this phone is also pretty good, with just about the right colour accuracy and viewing angles. The whole form-factor reminds us of the Xiaomi Mi 4i.

The Kult 10 though takes another hit in the camera department. The 13MP rear shooter is lower than competitors, and is just about average for the price range. Colour saturation isn't very good and there's quite a bit of noise. The front-facing camera isn't a any good either.

COOLPAD NOTE 3

This phone does consistently in all our tests. While we would have preferred a 1080p resolution on the 5.5-inch display, 720p is still reasonable. Moreover, the display quality is among the best in sub-10k smartphone category with crisp, warm colours that most would like. The Coolpad Note 3 may not stand out in terms of design though. It has a boring candy-bar shape and doesn't look very attractive.

It is still one of the best performers when it comes to processor performance. While it may not be the best in terms of synthetic benchmarks, real life performance was far better than most in this comparison. Be it day to day tasks, such as browsing the web, or long gaming sessions, the phone was able to handle it all. There is a slight lag at times after prolonged gaming sessions, but it's a small hitch.

The 13MP rear shooter is also good. Images taken



Coolpad Note 3

in daylight conditions have decent details and true-to-source colours. Even in low light, the noise reduction algorithm keeps noise to a minimum, without compromising on details.

However, the best attribute of this phone is its battery life. The 3000mAh battery is well optimised, lasting almost ten hours on a single charge.

XOLO BLACK 1X

The Xolo Black 1X is one of the best smartphones in this shootout. While it has the same SoC as the Coolpad Note 3, the Xolo Black 1X performs marginally lower than that device, especially on synthetic benchmarks. Even in real world performance,

the two phones are quite close and leave very little to differentiate them from each other.

In using the phone as your daily driver, it feels pretty good and fluid to use, very similar to the best phones in this price range. Normal tasks such as browsing the web, playing music or just watching a FHD movie are done quite well and though budget phones will eventually start doing even better, this is definitely amongst the best right now. We even tried heavy gaming on the phone, and the phone did quite well there too.

The Xolo Black 1X is also one of the few phones in this price range to boast a metal frame on its side. The Micromax Canvas Pulse 4G also has the same. The faux leather back on the Black 1X should appeal to some as well. The physical buttons are a little tough to press, but nothing that would really hamper day to day usage of the phone.

The Black 1X's biggest win, is in the fact that it has a 1080p display, being the only one to boast such a spec amongst the eight phones in this comparison. As a result the 5-inch IPS panel obviously has the highest pixel density and is sharper than all the other displays. Perhaps more important though, is the fact that the Xolo Black 1X does well in terms of colour saturation and viewing angles. We would have preferred if Xolo put more thought into the phone's UI though.

Talking about the camera, the Xolo Black has a 13MP shooter on the back, and even though the image quality is decent, the camera does lack sufficient details. The colour reproduction is respectable, and the shutter delay is less than ideal.

The 5MP front facing camera is similar to most other phones in this price bracket, but features a front-facing flash, which may come in handy for those night time selfies. The Xolo Black 1X also has a 2400 mAh battery, which is somewhat of a downer, thanks to only six hours of battery life on real world usage.

INTEX AQUA ACE

If the Intex Cloud Swift was a disappointment, the Intex Aqua Ace is the polar opposite of that phone. The difference in build and design between the two phones is huge and the Intex Aqua Ace is definitely one of the best looking phones in this sub-10K price category. It weighs just 121.5 grams and is only 6.7mm thick, which means that it is lighter and slimmer than any other phone in this comparison. It also feels much more premium than the rest of the phones that we compared, except perhaps the Micromax Canvas Pulse 4G, which we will talk about in just a moment.

While the glossy plastic on the Intex Aqua Ace does look good, it is somewhat of a fingerprint magnet. The 5-inch 720p panel on the Aqua Ace isn't great, especially when compared to the Xolo Black 1X. While the viewing angles are decent, the colour saturation, temperature and sunlight visibility of the display are quite average. Unlike the Intex Cloud Swift, this phone carries a more stock-like user interface, which is something that many Android users would really like, as do we.

The disappointing bit about the Intex Aqua Ace though is its camera, which is not the best feature of this phone. The 13MP rear camera is an average shooter, and images taken by it